

nucleus to which all of the players' other shared Backgrounds are tied. No secondary pooled Background may have a higher rating than the anchor.

For example, the members of a motley wish to have a shared household and all the benefits that go along with it. As such, they designate Holdings as their anchor Background. Between the players, they have enough Background points to gain 4 dots in Holdings, giving the motley a large, moderately powerful freehold. The group then decides that it must have an equally impressive staff, so they pool Retinue at 4 dots to match Holdings. The group cannot give Retinue 5 dots because their anchor Background, Holdings, is 4 dots.

The motley enjoys its freehold until a Dauntain attacks. The players fend off the assault, but not before the freehold's balefire is partially extinguished, reducing the group's Holdings to 3. Because Holdings is the anchor Background, the other shared Background, Retinue, can no longer be rated at 4. It must also be reduced to 3. The Storyteller rules that the group's freehold no longer produces enough Glamour to keep everyone enchanted, so some staff must be let go.

Upper Limits

By pooling Backgrounds, they may surpass the normal 5-dot limit. Though there is no absolute upper limit, to prevent things from spiraling out of proportion, the Storyteller might impose a 10 limit on the anchor Background.

The Storyteller should consider adjusting how the Backgrounds scale. Instead of following the progression, she may increase the Background's reliability. For example, if the motley has a freehold with a rating of 8, it doesn't make sense for their freehold to put Tara-Nar to shame. Instead, the freehold may be much more difficult to capture. It's important to balance player expectation with the needs of the chronicle.

Willpower

Willpower is a character's determination in the face of hardship or discipline against temptation. When external forces threaten to overwhelm her or when she is about to lose control of herself, Willpower allows her to steel herself and hold on to her personal narrative.

On the character sheet, permanent Willpower is recorded using dots, while temporary Willpower is tracked using squares below the dots. Spending a Willpower point removes one from the temporary pool, not the permanent rating. A character's permanent Willpower is the upper limit to her temporary pool. If a character spends all of her Willpower, she becomes too physically and mentally exhausted to push past her limits.

Willpower Ratings

●	Spineless
●●	Weak
●●●	Unassertive
●●●●	Diffident
●●●●●	Certain
●●●●●●	Confident

●●●●●●●●	Determined
●●●●●●●●●	Controlled
●●●●●●●●●●	Iron-Willed
●●●●●●●●●●●	Unshakable

Using Willpower

Some uses for Willpower include:

- Automatic Success
- Overcoming Compulsion
- Clearing Bedlam
- Ignoring Injury

Chapter Six: Systems and Drama contains more details about using Willpower.

Recovering Willpower

If a character fulfills his primary Legacy, he may regain Willpower. The Storyteller may award the player up to 5 Willpower points depending of the magnitude accomplishment.

The character may also regain a point of Willpower after a restful, uninterrupted sleep in which he dreams. If his sleep is troubled, the Storyteller may choose not to award any Willpower.

Characters may completely regain their Willpower at the end of a story. If the characters end the story defeated or demoralized, the Storyteller may restrict how much, if any, Willpower they regain.

If a character's temporary Willpower is depleted, he may convert one permanent point into a number of temporary points equaling his new permanent Willpower.

Glamour

Glamour is raw dream-stuff: passion and tragedy, hope and fear, joy and sorrow. It is anything that drives a person to experience intense emotion, break out of her daily drudgery, and fulfill her potential. It is seen in the artist who forsakes a safe career to realize her vision. It radiates from the astronomer who works to unlock the secrets of the universe. It reveals itself in the devout believer inspired to bring her community social justice.

The Glamour Trait represents a character's connection to the building blocks of the Dreaming. The higher the permanent Glamour rating, the more control she may exert over the chimerical world. Like Willpower, temporary Glamour may not exceed permanent Glamour.

Uses for Glamour

A few uses for Glamour include:

- Casting Cantrips
- Calling the Wyrd
- Enchanting a Mortal
- Sealing an Oath

Chapter Six: Systems and Drama contains more information about using Glamour.